

Kitchen Remodel Cost Planner

Build a line-item budget before selections and construction begin

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Plan first. Price second.

This 12-page field guide is designed to be used beside HomeCostEngine calculators, measurements, product selections and contractor proposals. It does not try to replace a site inspection or local professional. Instead, it helps you make assumptions visible so quotes become easier to understand and compare.

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Use this guide for planning and education only. Verify final pricing, code, permits, suitability and scope with qualified local professionals.

KITCHEN REMODELING

Define the remodel level

Decide whether the project is a cosmetic refresh, replacement-in-place or layout-changing renovation. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for mixing a simple cabinet refinish with structural, plumbing or electrical relocation. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Write the intended level of intervention before requesting prices.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

What is the one assumption on this page that could change your price or contractor scope? Write it down before moving to the next chapter.

KITCHEN REMODELING

Budget cabinets and millwork

Separate box construction, door style, hardware, panels, trim and installation.

The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for a cabinet allowance that excludes fillers, panels, crown or installation details. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Request a complete cabinet schedule and installation scope.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

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KITCHEN REMODELING

Plan countertops and backsplash

Measure surface quantity and identify material, edge, sink cutouts, backsplash and templating. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for comparing slab price without fabrication, cutouts or installation. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Ask for a fabricated installed price with assumptions listed.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

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KITCHEN REMODELING

Control appliance decisions

Track appliance dimensions, utilities, delivery, installation and cabinetry impacts. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for changing appliance models after cabinets and rough-ins are committed. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Freeze critical dimensions before final cabinet ordering.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

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KITCHEN REMODELING

Map plumbing and electrical

List sink, faucet, disposal, dishwasher, refrigerator, lighting, outlets and circuit changes. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for assuming relocation is included in a basic replacement budget. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Show each relocated fixture or new circuit in the written scope.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

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KITCHEN REMODELING

Plan finishes and labor

Budget flooring, paint, trim, drywall repair, protection and final cleanup. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for focusing on cabinets and forgetting the work required to finish surrounding surfaces. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Create a room-finish checklist tied to each trade.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

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KITCHEN REMODELING

Hold contingency for unknowns

Reserve money for concealed conditions while keeping upgrades in separate allowance lines. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for spending contingency early on decorative upgrades. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Approve changes against the correct budget bucket.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

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Project checklist

Resolve or document each item before you approve the final scope or purchase decision.

- Remodel level defined
- Cabinet schedule complete
- Countertop fabrication scope
- Appliance dimensions frozen
- Plumbing and electrical changes
- Finish work included
- Contingency protected

CHECKPOINT

Any unchecked item is not automatically a problem. It is a prompt to clarify responsibility, price or assumptions in writing before money is committed.

WORKING DOCUMENT

Budget worksheet

Keep planned amounts, actual quotes and notes together. Do not hide allowances or contingency inside one total.

Cabinets	Planned: \$ _____
Countertops	Planned: \$ _____
Appliances	Planned: \$ _____
Plumbing	Planned: \$ _____
Electrical and lighting	Planned: \$ _____
Flooring and paint	Planned: \$ _____
Permits and design	Planned: \$ _____
Contingency	Planned: \$ _____

Update this worksheet whenever a quote, selection or change order changes the project.

Next steps

You now have a practical framework for kitchen remodeling planning. Move from generic assumptions to real measurements, written product selections and comparable local proposals as your project becomes more defined.

Use HomeCostEngine next

- Run the relevant free calculator at homecostengine.com.
- Compare contractor proposals with matching scope and allowances.
- Keep a separate contingency instead of hiding uncertainty inside fixed costs.
- Save this guide with your quotes, selections and final project records.

HOME COST PLANNING - CLEARER ASSUMPTIONS - BETTER QUESTIONS

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Educational planning resource only. Always verify project-specific decisions with qualified local professionals.